

relays signs such as 'School ahead' and turns, making it a very complete navigation assistance setup. This is further paired with five cameras spread across the car, which helps you to see around tight corners on along narrow alleyways on the central display.

The assisted drive features of the 2017 Volvo XC60 also include hands-free parking, capable of recognising parallel and perpendicular parking spots, along with park-out. The suspen-

outperforms the Harman/Kardon audio systems of BMW, and the Canton setup used by Skoda – which happen to be among the best in their respective classes. Couple that with great surround audio performance, and what you get is one of the best in-car audio setups that you can get at around this price. Only Mercedes-Benz's Burmester-powered audio systems sound as splendid and rich as the Bowers & Wilkins speakers do in the Volvo XC60.

DESIGN

The compact dimensions make the car look much better than the XC90. It looks more proportionate – Thor's Hammer headlamps, slightly bulging body, swept-out back and the side-hugging tail LEDs all flow seamlessly. It looks like a body that's been built purposefully from scratch, and looks even sleeker than competitors like the Mercedes-Benz GLE and the BMW X5.



The infotainment looks like someone put a tablet into the dash, and we're not complaining, at all!



The feel of the steering is something that let's down an otherwise brilliant experience. Just a tad too light for our taste



We love how the side hugging tail-lights flow seamlessly to give this thing a pretty good looking back end to match the front

sion height can also be adjusted as per terrain, and stiffen/soften accordingly. You can also lower the suspension to load luggage in to the pretty spacious boot – just press the switch on the inner right side of the boot space.

The front seats get electronic adjustments for pitch, recline, side bolstering, thigh support, lumbar support, and four different massage patterns that can be adjusted in terms of speed and intensity, thereby matching the comfort of a BMW 7's seat in terms of support and comfort. The front lights can also be put on active bending mode, which turn according to the trajectory of the car. This is further highlighted with cornering lights, which in combination with the front cameras, make for supreme visibility on turns.

AUDIO

The Volvo XC60 includes a 15-speaker Bowers & Wilkins audio setup, along with a subwoofer that is concealed very well to avoid discontinuity in design. The highs are prominent, bass delivery is solid, and mid frequencies are not compromised in any way. It certainly

DRIVE

The 2017 Volvo XC60 comes to India only in its top-trim Inscription, powered by a 2-litre, 4-cylinder turbo-charged diesel engine that produces 234bhp and a staggering 480Nm of torque. The AWD SUV is paired with an 8-speed automatic gearbox, which changes the gear ratios depending on the mode that you're driving in.

The engine is more than adequately powerful, and despite being a turbo-charged diesel engine, it comes with a proprietary Volvo technology called 'PowerPulse'. This includes a small tank of compressed air within the comparatively tiny diesel engine. When the car starts and before the turbocharger kicks in, the PowerPulse tank pulses short bits of pressurised air into the engine's pistons to make up for the lack in turbo power at the start.

The only disappointment is in the rather light steering wheel. While everything about this SUV feels impeccably balanced, the steering wheel is a tad too light for a car of its dimensions. It's fine in the city, but on highways you feel a slight sense of disconnect.

On the inside, the new XC60 includes a new open pore veneer trim on the dash that is finished very smoothly, and comes with three leather trims – amber, beige and dark tan. The dark tan, in particular, makes the contrasting shades pop really nicely, and look premium. You get plenty of lighting inside, a three-zone automatic climate control system, a panoramic sunroof and ample legroom for every passenger of the five-seater SUV.

VERDICT

The new Volvo XC60 has a lot of tempting elements on offer for luxury SUV buyers, and can provoke a serious thought to divert away from the usual preferences. Volvo states that the XC60 is its best selling car across the world, and we expect the 2017 Volvo XC60 to be the same in India, as well. Priced very competitively at ₹55.9 lac (ex-showroom, pan-India), the 2017 Volvo XC60 has everything that it takes to finally make Volvo gain a larger share of the Indian luxury car market. Going by the amount of technology that it comes with, we expect it to really make a mark. **D**